City of Cambridge

RES 2026-135
FIRST IN COUNCIL
September 28, 2026

COUNCILLOR SIMMONS

WHEREAS: Ralph D'Agostino was born in Malden, Massachusetts, on September 28, 1936, to Rafael D'Agostino and C. Mary Parlatore, Italian immigrants who settled in Everett and raised him with the values they had carried across an ocean: love of family, pride in honest work, and devotion to the city that had taken them in – values Ralph has lived by for ninety years without exception; and

WHEREAS: Ralph began earning his own way at the age of eleven as a paperboy, and worked in the neighborhood markets that formed the civic backbone of his generation – a young man learning, even then, that a city is only as strong as the people who show up for it every day; and

WHEREAS: At the age of eighteen, Ralph answered his country's call, serving with honor in the United States Army from 1955 to 1956 and stationed in Incheon, South Korea, where he took part in engineering and construction operations supporting American military infrastructure on a peninsula still raw from war – returning home with the quiet dignity of a man who had gone when asked and had done what was needed; and

WHEREAS: Ralph's lifelong devotion to music began with accordion lessons in Boston's North End and included an appearance on the Italian Radio Hour on Sunday morning, and it was as an accordionist performing at a dance that he encountered the woman who would become the center of his world: Marie "Mae" Cross, known to her family as "Babe," whom he married in 1962 and to whom he devoted himself completely for fifty-one years, until her passing in 2013 – a love story that began with music and never stopped; and

WHEREAS: From that marriage grew a family that is itself Ralph's greatest achievement: his children Robyn and Carl; his grandchildren Lou, Jen, Colin, Marc, Alec, Eric, and Jake, and his great-grandchildren Callum and Lukas – a family built brick by brick across six decades through the same faithfulness and warmth Ralph brought to everything he touched; and

WHEREAS: Ralph began his career in the food industry as a meat cutter and rose to lead the meat department at several Star Market locations before becoming a distinguished entrepreneur and restaurateur, operating 3D's in Everett, RD's in Melrose, and Cutlet Cuisine in Stoneham, which later became D'Agostino's Restaurant – businesses that did not merely feed people but gathered them, gave them a place to be, and embedded Ralph's name in the daily life of communities across Greater Boston for decades; and

WHEREAS: Throughout his life Ralph has continued to perform as a musician, bringing to audiences the same talent and warmth with which he first charmed Mae across a

dance floor, and he continues to play the accordion and keyboard to this day – because a gift like that is not something a man like Ralph sets down; and

WHEREAS: Ralph D'Agostino has spent ninety years as a presence in Everett – known throughout the city and the far reaches of his extended family as "Uncle Chubby" and "Uncle Ralph," as a reader of history and biography, as a devoted student of classic film, as a man who will as readily research a corner of the past that caught his curiosity as he will spend an afternoon on the golf course or, in one of the great democratizing joys of modern life, watching cat videos on YouTube; and

WHEREAS: In an act that speaks to the depth of Ralph's character as clearly as any other, he has committed his memories to writing – composing a collection of personal memoirs to preserve the texture of his life, the lessons of his years, and the stories of a world that his grandchildren and great-grandchildren deserve to know: a gift to his family as enduring as any he could give; now therefore be it

RESOLVED: That the City Council go on record wishing Ralph D'Agostino a Happy 90th Birthday, with many happy, healthy birthdays yet to come; and be it further

RESOLVED: That the City Clerk be and hereby is requested to forward a suitably engrossed copy of this resolution to Ralph D'Agostino on behalf of the entire City Council.

A true copy;

ATTEST:- Paula M. Crane

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk

City of Cambridge

Happy 90th Birthday to Ralph D'Agostino.